HELICOPTER YATRA MAKES HISTORIC DEBUT FOR ADI KAILASH AND OM PARVAT IN UTTARAKHAND

Uttarakhand
Simply Heaven!





"In April this year, Delhi-based advocate Roachak Saxsena found himself at the heart of a historic moment. He was part of the very first batch of pilgrims to embark on a helicopter yatra to the sacred Adi Kailash, organized by the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board (UTDB). Saxsena, overwhelmed by the experience, described it as "mesmerizing." Witnessing Lord Shiva's abode without the usual arduous trek left him speechless. He credits Uttarakhand Tourism and Trip to Temples for making this dream a reality and enthusiastically recommends it to his loved ones."

Nestled in the Vyas valley of Pithoragarh district, Adi Kailash holds immense religious significance. It's one of the five revered Panch Kailash yatras, believed to be the second abode of Lord Shiva and Parvati. Adding to the mystical aura of the region is Om Parvat, a natural wonder located on the India-Nepal-Tibet border. This mountain boasts a perfect "Om" shape, visible only from the Indian side. The ideal vantage point for this breathtaking sight is Nabhidang, a mere 11 kilometers from the Old Lipu Lekh pass.

Determined to make Adi Kailash and Om Parvat more accessible to devotees and tourists, the Uttarakhand Tourism Development Board launched a groundbreaking initiative this year: the aerial yatra. The inaugural batch of this unique pilgrimage took off on April 15th, with flights continuing until May 9th. Following this initial run, the yatra will reopen its doors to the public during the winter months (November to March) to accommodate the seasonal snow cover.

This innovative project is the product of a successful partnership between UTDB and Noida-based travel agency Trip to Temples. UTDB played a crucial role in securing the necessary approvals and laying the groundwork for the yatra. Trip to Temples, on the other hand, brings its expertise in marketing and operations to the table, ensuring a smooth and enriching experience for pilgrims.

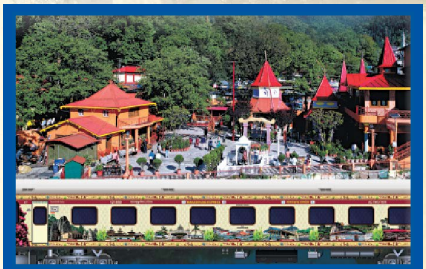
The winter yatra, designed for the months of November to March, will be a four-night, five-day package starting and ending in Pithoragarh. Pilgrims will be transported by modern H-125 helicopters, with ATVs providing additional support for navigating the terrain. The itinerary promises six exhilarating helicopter rides, offering breathtaking aerial views of the majestic Himalayas.

"The aerial yatra to Adi Kailash and Om Parvat has been initiated by Uttarakhand Tourism," Uttarakhand Tourism Secretary and UTDB CEO Sachin Kurve told India Today. "The first public yatra commenced on April 15th and will continue until May 9. We'll then resume operations in the winter months, from November to March."

The yatra goes beyond simply providing access to sacred sites. It also aims to empower local communities. Pilgrims will be accommodated in cozy homestays located in the charming villages of Gunji, Nabhi, and Napalchu. This approach not only provides a unique cultural experience but also generates much-needed winter employment opportunities for local residents.

"This helicopter yatra marks a significant step forward in making the wonders of Uttarakhand more accessible to a wider range of pilgrims and tourists. It not only offers a breathtaking journey but also fosters responsible tourism practices that benefit local communities."

Vikas Mishra, the Founder and CEO of Trip to Temples, expressed his company's immense pride in being part of this historic project. He looks forward to future collaborations and contributing to the development of sustainable and accessible pilgrimage experiences in Uttarakhand.



Manaskhand Express Special Tourist Train

Uttarakhand Tourism has entered into an Agreement with IRCTC to provide Tours to hidden destinations of Uttarakhand through a Special Tourist Train, the first trip of which started from Pune on 22.04.2024 on 10 Nights/11 Days journey.

While the itineraries have been curated to include places in the Udham Singh Nagar, Champawat, Pithorgarh, Almora and Nainital districts, the end to end services are being provided by IRCTC and the bookings are also available on the irctctourism.com website.

This unique initiative aims to expose some of the best kept secrets of Uttarakhand to citizens from different parts of the country.